

PARAKH (NAS) PRACTICE - SOCIAL STUDIES

Early Human Society: From Nomadism to Early Civilisation

Competency: Analyses the effect of various changes in early human society - from nomadism to settled life and early civilisation (emergence of agriculture, changes in food habits, basic technologies like construction, transport, pottery, metallurgy), changes in human habitation, family structures and relationships, the nature of work, and socio-cultural beliefs over time (e.g. Ahimsa, and the fallout of major wars or invasions).

Suitable for Classes 6 to 9 (NCERT 'Our Past's' / SCERT Telangana Social Studies)

General Instructions

1. This booklet has 52 multiple-choice questions (MCQs) for practice.
2. Each question has four options - A, B, C and D. Only ONE is correct.
3. Nine PARAKH question formats are used, grouped section-wise.
4. The Answer Key with brief explanations is given at the end.
5. Attempt all questions. There is no negative marking in NAS.

Total questions: 52 | Format: nine PARAKH item types | Reference pattern: NAS 2024 model paper (Grade 9).

About the sources (read before verifying):

Each question shows a 'Reference from:' line giving book -> class -> chapter -> concept. Exact page numbers are intentionally omitted because they vary by edition/print-year - share the specific textbook PDF to pin exact pages. Items marked [!] stretch beyond the core Class 6-8 text (verify in a Class 9/higher text) before use with students.

SECTION 1 - MATCH THE FOLLOWING

Match List I with List II and choose the correct answer using the codes given.

1. Match the age with its main feature.

List I (Age)

- A. Palaeolithic (Old Stone Age)
- B. Mesolithic (Middle Stone Age)
- C. Neolithic (New Stone Age)
- D. Chalcolithic

List II (Feature)

- 1. Polished tools; farming begins
- 2. Rough tools; hunting-gathering
- 3. Microliths (tiny stone tools)
- 4. Use of copper along with stone

- A.** A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
- B.** A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
- C.** A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
- D.** A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past's-I', Ch.2 'On the Trail of the Earliest People' & Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS (early humans). Concept: Stone Age periods & tools. [!] 'Chalcolithic' label - verify in Class 9/higher text.

2. Match the site with its location / feature.

List I (Site)

- A. Harappa
- B. Mohenjodaro
- C. Mehrgarh
- D. Lothal

List II (Location / Feature)

- 1. On the river Ravi
- 2. On the river Indus
- 3. Early farming village
- 4. Dockyard (sea trade)

- A.** A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
- B.** A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
- C.** A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4 'In the Earliest Cities' (Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Lothal) & Ch.3 (Mehrgarh); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: Harappan sites & locations.

3. Match the technology with what it enabled.

List I (Technology)

- A. Pottery
- B. Wheel
- C. Metallurgy
- D. Spinning & weaving

List II (Use)

- 1. Storing grain and cooking food
- 2. Transport and making pots
- 3. Metal tools and ornaments
- 4. Making cloth

- A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4**
- B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4**
- C. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3**
- D. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1**

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4 (pottery, wheel, metal, spinning/weaving); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS - production & crafts. Concept: early technologies and their uses.

4. Match the person / text with the belief or idea.

List I (Person / Text)

- A. Mahavira
- B. Gautama Buddha
- C. Ashoka
- D. Vedas

List II (Belief / Idea)

- 1. Ahimsa and Jainism
- 2. Buddhism and the Middle Path
- 3. Dhamma after the Kalinga war
- 4. Earliest sacred texts

- A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4**
- B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4**
- C. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3**
- D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2**

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.7 'New Questions and Ideas' (Mahavira, Buddha, Ahimsa), Ch.8 'Ashoka...' (dhamma), Ch.5 (Vedas); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS - religion & society. Concept: beliefs & thinkers.

5. Match the source with what it tells us.

List I (Source)

- A. Stone tools
- B. Burials & megaliths
- C. Seals, bricks (Harappan)
- D. Inscriptions

List II (Tells us about)

- 1. How early people hunted / cut
- 2. Beliefs about death
- 3. Life in the earliest cities
- 4. Orders of kings like Ashoka

- A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4**
- B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4**
- C. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3**
- D. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1**

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.1 'What, Where, How and When?' (sources), Ch.2 (tools), Ch.5 (burials/megaliths), Ch.4 (Harappan remains); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: sources of history.

6. Match the way of life with the kind of work.

List I (Way of life)

- A. Hunter-gatherers
- B. Herders
- C. Farmers
- D. Craftspersons

List II (Kind of work)

- 1. Hunting animals, gathering plants
- 2. Rearing / domesticating animals
- 3. Growing crops
- 4. Making pots, beads, tools

A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4

B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

C. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

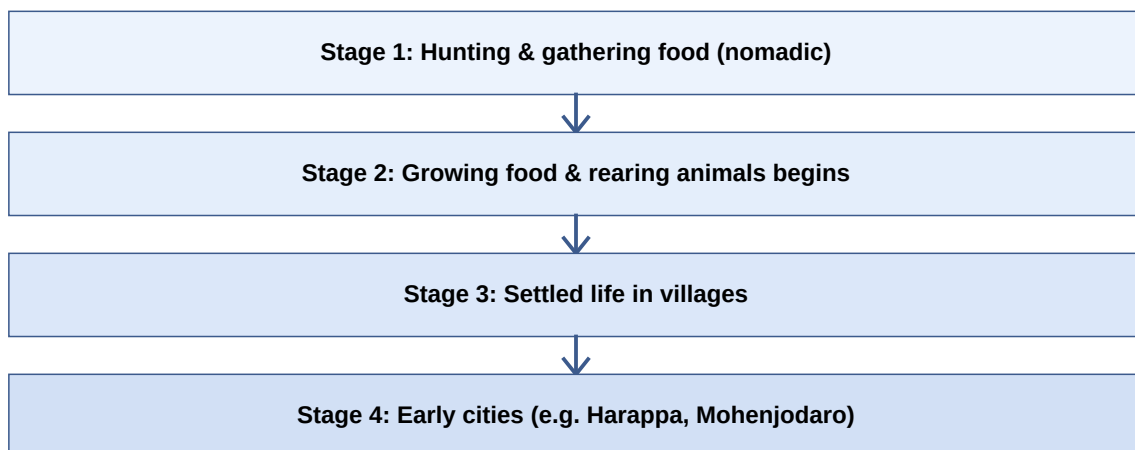
Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2 & Ch.3 (hunter-gatherers, herders, farmers, crafts); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS - livelihoods/work. Concept: ways of life & work.

SECTION 2 - FIGURE-BASED QUESTIONS

Study the given figure carefully and answer the question that follows.

7. Figure A shows how early human society changed over time. The change from Stage 1 to Stage 2 was mainly caused by:

Figure A: How early human society changed over time

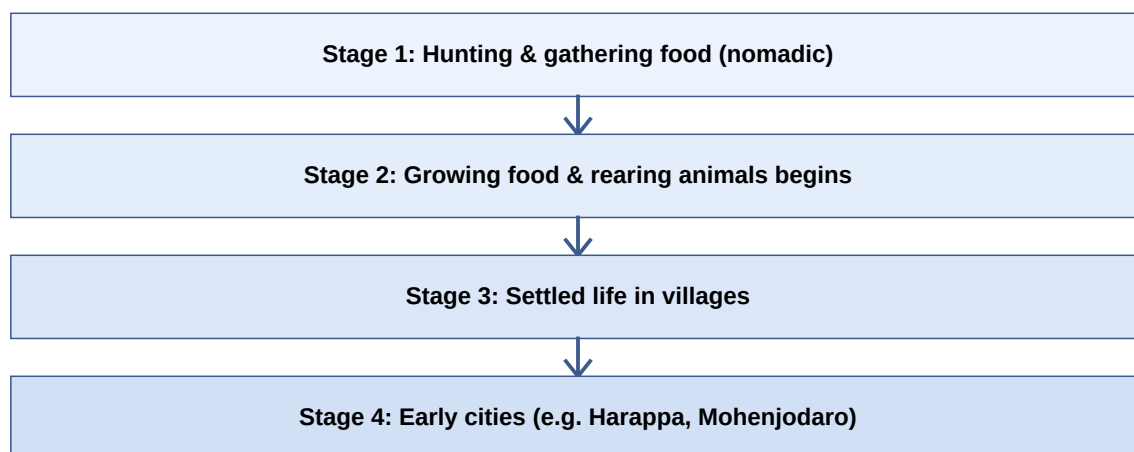


- A.** The beginning of agriculture and the domestication of animals
- B.** The invention of the printing press
- C.** The building of railways
- D.** The discovery of electricity

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: agriculture caused the shift to settled life.

8. In Figure A, at which stage did people first begin to live a settled life in permanent villages?

Figure A: How early human society changed over time

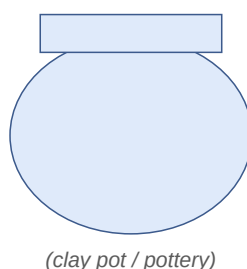


- A. Stage 1 - hunting and gathering
- B. Stage 2 - growing food and rearing animals
- C. Stage 3 - settled villages
- D. Stage 4 - cities

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 (settled villages) & Ch.4 (cities); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: settled life begins with farming villages.

9. The figure shows a clay pot made by early people. Pottery like this was mainly useful for:

Figure B: A clay pot made by early people

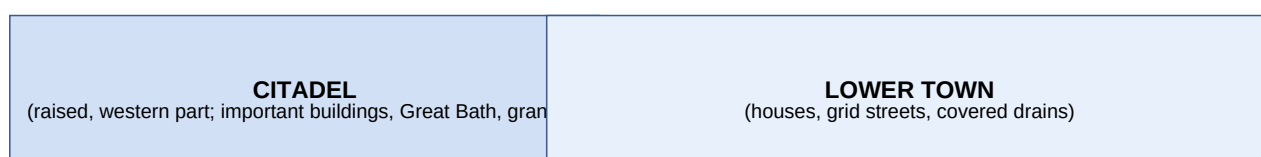


- A. Flying across rivers
- B. Storing grain and cooking food
- C. Writing books
- D. Making iron weapons

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4 (pottery for storage & cooking); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: use of pottery.

10. The figure shows the plan of a Harappan city. The raised western part, where important buildings stood, is called the:

Figure C: Plan of a Harappan city

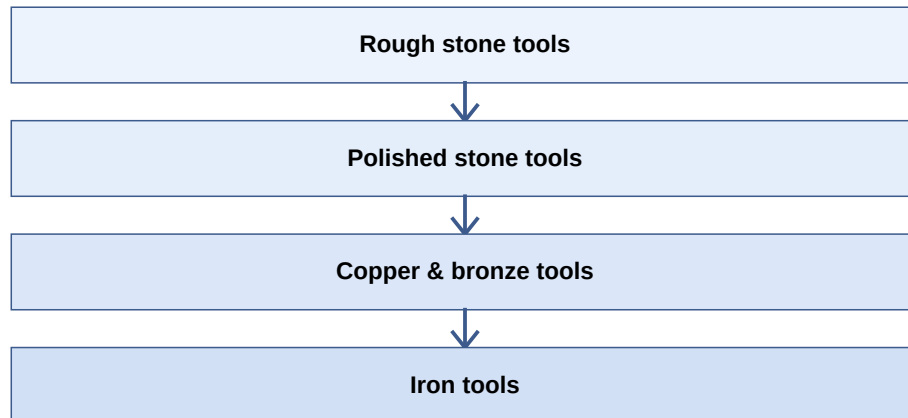


- A. Citadel
- B. Lower Town
- C. Dockyard
- D. Stupa

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 'In the Earliest Cities' (Citadel & Lower Town); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: Harappan town planning.

11. The figure shows how tools changed over time. This improvement was mainly due to the development of:

Figure D: How tools changed over time (earlier -> later)



- A. Printing
- B. Metallurgy (the use of metals)
- C. Electricity
- D. The steam engine

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (metals) & later chapters (iron); SCERT Telangana Class 6/8 SS. Concept: metallurgy improved tools. (Matches NAS 2024 Grade 9 Q3.)

SECTION 3 - ARRANGE IN CHRONOLOGICAL / SEQUENTIAL ORDER

Arrange the items as directed and choose the correct sequence.

12. Arrange the stages of early human society from the EARLIEST to the LATEST:

- (i) Living in cities (Harappa)
- (ii) Hunting and gathering (nomadic)
- (iii) Settled village farming
- (iv) Growing food and rearing animals begins

- A. (ii), (iv), (iii), (i)
- B. (i), (iii), (iv), (ii)
- C. (ii), (iii), (iv), (i)
- D. (iv), (ii), (iii), (i)

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2-4; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: order - hunting-gathering -> farming -> villages -> cities.

13. Arrange the ages in chronological order (earliest first):

- (i) Iron Age (ii) Old Stone Age (iii) New Stone Age (iv) Chalcolithic (Copper-Stone)

- A. (ii), (iii), (iv), (i)
- B. (ii), (iv), (iii), (i)
- C. (iii), (ii), (i), (iv)
- D. (i), (ii), (iii), (iv)

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2-4 (Old/New Stone Age, metals); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. [!] 'Chalcolithic' & 'Iron Age' labels - verify in Class 9/higher text. Concept: order of ages.

14. Arrange the steps by which people began to grow food and settle:

- (i) Observing seeds sprouting where they fell
- (ii) Deliberately sowing seeds and growing crops
- (iii) Staying near the fields to tend the crops
- (iv) Settling down in villages

- A.** (i), (ii), (iii), (iv)
- B.** (ii), (i), (iii), (iv)
- C.** (i), (iii), (ii), (iv)
- D.** (iv), (iii), (ii), (i)

*Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS.
Concept: how food-growing and settling began.*

15. Arrange these technologies in the order they generally appeared:

- (i) Use of iron tools
- (ii) Use of copper and bronze
- (iii) Use of stone tools
- (iv) Use of the potter's wheel

- A.** (iii), (iv), (ii), (i)
- B.** (iii), (ii), (iv), (i)
- C.** (iv), (iii), (ii), (i)
- D.** (i), (ii), (iv), (iii)

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2-4 (stone -> pottery -> copper/bronze -> iron); SCERT Telangana Class 6/8 SS. Concept: order of technologies.

16. Arrange the events of Ashoka's change of heart in the correct order:

- (i) Ashoka fought the Kalinga war
- (ii) Great loss of life and suffering in Kalinga
- (iii) Ashoka felt deep remorse and gave up war
- (iv) Ashoka spread the message of dhamma and ahimsa

- A.** (i), (ii), (iii), (iv)
- B.** (ii), (i), (iii), (iv)
- C.** (i), (iii), (ii), (iv)
- D.** (iv), (iii), (ii), (i)

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.8 'Ashoka, the Emperor Who Gave Up War' (Kalinga -> remorse -> dhamma); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: fallout of war.

17. Arrange the kinds of human habitation from the EARLIEST to the LATEST:

- (i) Cities (ii) Caves and rock shelters (iii) Villages

- A.** (ii), (iii), (i)
- B.** (i), (iii), (ii)
- C.** (iii), (ii), (i)
- D.** (ii), (i), (iii)

*Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2-4 (caves/shelters -> villages -> cities); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS.
Concept: order of settlement types.*

SECTION 4 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS CORRECT

Read the four statements and choose the **CORRECT** one.

18. Which statement about early hunter-gatherers is **CORRECT**?

- A. They lived permanently in big cities.
- B. They moved from place to place in search of food.
- C. They used iron tools for farming.
- D. They wrote books about their lives.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2 'On the Trail of the Earliest People'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: nomadic hunter-gatherers.

19. Which statement about the beginning of agriculture is **CORRECT**?

- A. It made people wander even more than before.
- B. It led people to settle down in one place.
- C. It ended the use of all tools.
- D. It stopped people from rearing animals.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: agriculture led to settled life.

20. Which statement about the Harappan (Indus Valley) civilisation is **CORRECT**?

- A. Its cities had no planning at all.
- B. Its cities had well-planned drainage and brick houses.
- C. Its people did not know any metal.
- D. It had no trade with other regions.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4 'In the Earliest Cities'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: Harappan planning & drainage.

21. Which statement about metallurgy in early societies is **CORRECT**?

- A. Metals were never used for tools.
- B. The use of metals like copper and bronze improved tools and ornaments and boosted trade.
- C. Metallurgy reduced trade and commerce.
- D. Iron was the very first metal ever used by humans.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4 (metal use, trade); SCERT Telangana Class 6/8 SS. Concept: metallurgy boosted tools & trade. (Matches NAS 2024 Grade 9 Q3.)

22. Which statement about Ahimsa is **CORRECT**?

- A. It means the love of war.
- B. It means non-violence - not hurting living beings.
- C. It was an idea about farming tools.
- D. It was a kind of metal.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.7 'New Questions and Ideas' (Ahimsa); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: meaning of Ahimsa.

23. Which statement about sources for studying the Indus Valley civilisation is CORRECT?

- A. Colonial administrative records are the best source.
- B. Archaeological remains (seals, bricks, tools) are the most useful source.
- C. Printed newspapers are the best source.
- D. Modern school textbooks are primary sources.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.1 'What, Where, How and When?' & Ch.4; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: archaeological remains as primary source. (Matches NAS 2024 Grade 9 Q19.)

SECTION 5 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS INCORRECT

Read the four statements and choose the INCORRECT one.

24. Which statement about nomadic life is INCORRECT?

- A. People moved in search of food and water.
- B. People followed animal herds and the seasons.
- C. People built large permanent cities.
- D. People used stone tools.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: features of nomadic life.

25. Which statement about the New Stone Age (Neolithic) is INCORRECT?

- A. People began growing crops and rearing animals.
- B. People used polished stone tools.
- C. People started living in settled villages.
- D. People built railways and factories.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 (Neolithic villages, polished tools); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: New Stone Age features.

26. Which statement about pottery is INCORRECT?

- A. Pottery was used to store grain.
- B. Pottery was used for cooking food.
- C. Pottery was made using the potter's wheel.
- D. Pottery was used to fly across rivers.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4 (pottery uses & potter's wheel); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: use of pottery.

27. Which statement about the effects of early farming is INCORRECT?

- A. It changed people's food habits.
- B. It encouraged settled life.
- C. It led to the storage of surplus grain.
- D. It ended all hunting and gathering everywhere at once.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 (effects of farming: food habits, storage, settling); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: effects of agriculture.

28. Which statement about the Kalinga war is INCORRECT?

- A. It was fought by Ashoka.
- B. It caused great death and suffering.
- C. It made Ashoka give up war and follow ahimsa.
- D. It made Ashoka eager to fight many more wars.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8 'Ashoka...' (Kalinga war); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: Kalinga war & its effect.

29. Which statement about Harappan technology is INCORRECT?

- A. They made objects of bronze (copper + tin).
- B. They made beads, pots and seals.
- C. They planned cities with covered drains.
- D. They used electricity to light the streets.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (bronze, beads, seals, drains); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: Harappan technology.

SECTION 6 - IDENTIFY THE CORRECT PAIR

Only one of the four pairs is correctly matched. Identify it.

30. Identify the correctly matched pair (Age - Feature):

- A. Old Stone Age - Farming villages
- B. New Stone Age - Beginning of agriculture
- C. Iron Age - First stone tools
- D. Chalcolithic - No metal use

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2-4; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: age - feature.

31. Identify the correctly matched pair (Site - Feature):

- A. Lothal - Dockyard (sea trade)
- B. Harappa - Dockyard
- C. Mehrgarh - Large city with the Great Bath
- D. Mohenjodaro - Earliest farming village

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (Lothal, Mohenjodaro, Harappa) & Ch.3 (Mehrgarh); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: site - feature.

32. Identify the correctly matched pair (Person - Idea):

- A. Buddha - Founder of Jainism
- B. Mahavira - Ahimsa (Jainism)
- C. Ashoka - Started the Kalinga war for dhamma
- D. Rishis - Wrote about railways

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.7 (Mahavira - Ahimsa/Jainism); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: person - idea.

33. Identify the correctly matched pair (Technology - Use):

- A. Potter's wheel - Making cloth
- B. Spinning - Making pots
- C. Metallurgy - Making metal tools and ornaments
- D. Wheel - Storing grain

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4 (technologies & uses); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: technology - use.

34. Identify the correctly matched pair (Source - Information):

- A. Seals - Beliefs about death
- B. Megaliths / burials - Beliefs about death and the dead
- C. Iron tools - Hunting by Old Stone Age people
- D. Vedas - Harappan drainage plans

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.5 'What Books and Burials Tell Us' (megaliths/burials); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: source - information.

35. Identify the correctly matched pair (Change - Result):

- A. Agriculture - People became more nomadic
- B. Settled life - Growth of villages and later towns
- C. Metallurgy - Decline of trade
- D. Pottery - End of food storage

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4 (settled life -> villages/towns); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: change - result.

SECTION 7 - TWO STATEMENTS (Statement-1 & Statement-2)

Read both statements and choose which is/are correct.

36. Statement-1: Early humans were hunter-gatherers who moved from place to place.

Statement-2: The beginning of farming helped people settle down.

- A. Only Statement-1 is correct
- B. Only Statement-2 is correct
- C. Both statements are correct
- D. Both statements are incorrect

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2 & Ch.3; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: nomadism -> settled farming.

37. Statement-1: Old Stone Age people used polished stone tools and grew crops.

Statement-2: New Stone Age people used only rough, unpolished stone tools.

- A. Only Statement-1 is correct
- B. Only Statement-2 is correct
- C. Both statements are correct
- D. Both statements are incorrect

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2 & Ch.3 (Old vs New Stone Age tools - statements swapped); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: Stone Age tools.

38. Statement-1: Pottery helped people store food and cook.

Statement-2: Metallurgy allowed people to make tools and ornaments from metal.

- A. Only Statement-1 is correct
- B. Only Statement-2 is correct
- C. Both statements are correct
- D. Both statements are incorrect

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4 (pottery & metallurgy); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: early technologies.

39. Statement-1: Mahavira taught the idea of Ahimsa.

Statement-2: Mahavira invented iron tools.

- A. Only Statement-1 is correct
- B. Only Statement-2 is correct
- C. Both statements are correct
- D. Both statements are incorrect

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.7 (Mahavira & Ahimsa); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: Mahavira taught Ahimsa (did not invent tools).

40. Statement-1: The Harappan cities had planned drainage and brick buildings.

Statement-2: The Harappans had no contact or trade with other areas.

- A. Only Statement-1 is correct
- B. Only Statement-2 is correct
- C. Both statements are correct
- D. Both statements are incorrect

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (Harappan planning & trade); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: Harappan cities & trade.

41. Statement-1: After the Kalinga war, Ashoka gave up war and followed non-violence.

Statement-2: The war showed Ashoka that violence caused great suffering.

- A. Only Statement-1 is correct
- B. Only Statement-2 is correct
- C. Both statements are correct
- D. Both statements are incorrect

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8 'Ashoka...' (Kalinga war & change of heart); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: fallout of war.

SECTION 8 - ASSERTION - REASONING

Each item has an Assertion (A) and a Reason (R). Choose the correct option.

42. Assertion (A): The beginning of agriculture led to settled village life.

Reason (R): Once people started growing crops, they had to stay near the fields to tend and harvest them.

- A. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B. Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C. A is true but R is false
- D. A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: farming -> staying near fields -> settling.

- 43.** Assertion (A): The development of metallurgy increased trade and commerce in early societies.
Reason (R): Metal tools and ornaments were valued and were exchanged between regions.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (metal & trade); SCERT Telangana Class 6/8 SS. Concept: metallurgy -> trade. (Matches NAS 2024 Grade 9 Q3.)

- 44.** Assertion (A): Pottery was an important technology for early farmers.
Reason (R): Pots were used to store surplus grain and to cook food.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4 (pottery for grain storage & cooking); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: importance of pottery.

- 45.** Assertion (A): Ashoka gave up war after the battle of Kalinga.
Reason (R): Ashoka wanted to conquer many more lands through war.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8 'Ashoka...' (gave up war; did NOT want more conquest); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: Ashoka after Kalinga.

- 46.** Assertion (A): Archaeological remains are the most useful source for studying the Indus Valley civilisation.
Reason (R): The Harappan script has been fully read and translated by scholars.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.1 & Ch.4 (archaeology; Harappan script not yet deciphered); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: sources & undeciphered script. (Matches NAS 2024 Grade 9 Q19.)

- 47.** Assertion (A): Early humans made tools from stone.
Reason (R): India is a peninsula surrounded by water on three sides.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2 (stone tools); R about India's geography is from NCERT Class 6 Geography and is unrelated. Concept: A true, R unrelated.

SECTION 9 - PARAGRAPH / DATA-BASED QUESTIONS

Read the passage or data and answer the question that follows.

- 48.** Passage: 'Long ago a group of people lived by hunting deer and wild pigs and gathering fruits, roots and nuts. When the food in one area ran out, they packed up and moved to a new place.'

These people are best described as:

- A.** Farmers
- B.** Hunter-gatherers
- C.** City dwellers
- D.** Traders

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2 'On the Trail of the Earliest People'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: identifying hunter-gatherers.

- 49.** Passage: 'At the village of Mehrgarh, archaeologists found the bones of wild animals in the oldest layers, but in the later layers they found more and more bones of sheep and goats.'

This change in the bones best shows that the people had begun to:

- A.** Give up eating meat
- B.** Domesticate (rear) animals
- C.** Stop farming
- D.** Leave the village

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food' (Mehrgarh; wild -> domesticated animal bones); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: evidence of domestication.

- 50.** Passage: 'In a Harappan city the streets were laid out in a grid, and every house was connected to a covered drain that ran along the street.'

This passage shows that the Harappans had:

- A.** No knowledge of building
- B.** Careful town planning
- C.** Only tents to live in
- D.** No system for waste water

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 'In the Earliest Cities' (grid streets, covered drains); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: Harappan town planning.

- 51.** Data: A study of tools from one region showed - Old Stone Age: rough stone tools; New Stone Age: polished stone tools; a later period: copper tools; a still later period: iron tools.

The overall trend shown by this data is that tools were increasingly made:

- A.** Weaker over time
- B.** From better and harder materials over time
- C.** Only from wood
- D.** Smaller and useless

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2-4 (stone -> copper -> iron); SCERT Telangana Class 6/8 SS. Concept: tools from harder materials over time (data trend).

- 52.** Passage: 'After a terrible war in which lakhs of people were killed or taken prisoner, a powerful emperor felt deep sorrow. He gave up war forever and began to teach kindness and non-violence to all.'

The emperor and the idea he adopted are:

- A.** Ashoka - Ahimsa (non-violence)
- B.** Buddha - warfare
- C.** Mahavira - conquest
- D.** A Harappan king - trade

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8 'Ashoka, the Emperor Who Gave Up War' (Kalinga -> Ahimsa/dhamma); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: identifying Ashoka & Ahimsa.

ANSWER KEY WITH EXPLANATIONS

SECTION 1 - MATCH THE FOLLOWING

1. (A) Old Stone Age-rough tools & hunting; Middle Stone Age-microliths; New Stone Age-polished tools & farming; Chalcolithic-copper with stone.
2. (A) Harappa-on the Ravi; Mohenjodaro-on the Indus; Mehrgarh-early farming village; Lothal-dockyard site in Gujarat.
3. (A) Pottery-storing grain & cooking; Wheel-transport & the potter's wheel; Metallurgy-metal tools & ornaments; Spinning & weaving-making cloth.
4. (A) Mahavira-Ahimsa & Jainism; Buddha-Buddhism & the Middle Path; Ashoka-dhamma after Kalinga; Vedas-earliest sacred texts.
5. (A) Stone tools-how people hunted/cut; Burials & megaliths-beliefs about death; Harappan remains-city life; Inscriptions-orders of kings.
6. (A) Hunter-gatherers-hunt & gather; Herders-rear animals; Farmers-grow crops; Craftspersons-make pots, beads and tools.

SECTION 2 - FIGURE-BASED QUESTIONS

7. (A) Growing food and rearing animals (the start of agriculture) moved people from Stage 1 to Stage 2.
8. (C) Permanent settled life in villages first appears at Stage 3.
9. (B) Pots were used to store surplus grain and to cook food.
10. (A) The raised, walled western part of a Harappan city is the Citadel.
11. (B) Learning to use metals (metallurgy) made tools sharper and stronger.

SECTION 3 - ARRANGE IN CHRONOLOGICAL / SEQUENTIAL ORDER

12. (A) Hunting-gathering -> food-growing/herding begins -> settled villages -> cities.
13. (A) Old Stone Age -> New Stone Age -> Chalcolithic -> Iron Age.
14. (A) People noticed seeds sprouting, then sowed them, stayed to tend crops, and settled.
15. (A) Stone tools -> potter's wheel (Neolithic) -> copper/bronze -> iron.
16. (A) War -> suffering -> remorse and giving up war -> spreading dhamma/ahimsa.
17. (A) Caves / rock shelters -> villages -> cities.

SECTION 4 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS CORRECT

18. (B) Hunter-gatherers were nomadic, moving in search of food, water and shelter.
19. (B) Growing crops meant staying near the fields, so people began to settle down.
20. (B) Harappan cities were carefully planned, with brick houses and covered drains.
21. (B) Metals improved tools and ornaments and increased trade (copper was among the first metals used).
22. (B) Ahimsa means non-violence, an idea central to Jainism and Buddhism.
23. (B) Since the Harappan script is not yet deciphered, archaeological remains are the most useful source.

SECTION 5 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS INCORRECT

24. (C) Nomads did NOT build large permanent cities; they moved from place to place.
25. (D) Railways and factories belong to modern times, not the Neolithic.
26. (D) Pots cannot fly; they were used for storage, cooking and carrying.
27. (D) Hunting and gathering continued alongside farming for a long time; it did not end at once.
28. (D) After Kalinga, Ashoka gave up war; he did not seek more wars.

29. (D) The Harappans had no electricity; that is a modern technology.

SECTION 6 - IDENTIFY THE CORRECT PAIR

30. (B) The New Stone Age (Neolithic) is when agriculture began.
31. (A) Lothal in Gujarat had a dockyard used for trade by sea.
32. (B) Mahavira is linked with Ahimsa and Jainism.
33. (C) Metallurgy is the making of tools and ornaments from metal.
34. (B) Megaliths and burials tell us about people's beliefs regarding death.
35. (B) Settling down led to the growth of villages and, later, towns and cities.

SECTION 7 - TWO STATEMENTS (Statement-1 & Statement-2)

36. (C) Both statements are true.
37. (D) Both are wrong - the features are swapped (Old = rough & hunting; New = polished & farming).
38. (C) Both statements are true.
39. (A) Statement-1 is true; Mahavira taught Ahimsa but did not invent tools.
40. (A) Statement-1 is true; the Harappans DID trade with distant regions, so Statement-2 is false.
41. (C) Both statements are true.

SECTION 8 - ASSERTION - REASONING

42. (A) Both true; staying near the fields is exactly why farming led to settled life.
43. (A) Both true; the exchange of valued metal goods is why trade grew.
44. (A) Both true; storage and cooking are exactly why pottery mattered to farmers.
45. (C) A is true, but R is false - Ashoka gave up conquest, he did not want more war.
46. (C) A is true, but R is false - the Harappan script has NOT yet been deciphered.
47. (B) Both statements are true, but R (India's shape) does not explain A (stone tools).

SECTION 9 - PARAGRAPH / DATA-BASED QUESTIONS

48. (B) People who hunt, gather and keep moving are hunter-gatherers.
49. (B) More bones of sheep and goats over time show that people had started rearing (domesticating) animals.
50. (B) Grid streets and covered drains show careful town planning.
51. (B) Stone -> copper -> iron shows tools were made from progressively better, harder materials.
52. (A) This describes Ashoka, who adopted Ahimsa (non-violence) after the Kalinga war.

SOURCE & VERIFICATION SUMMARY

Book, class, chapter and concept below are dependable pointers to where this competency is taught. Page numbers are omitted on purpose (they change between editions); share the textbook PDF and verified page numbers can be added.

NCERT Class 6 - 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.1-2 (sources; earliest people & stone tools)

What/where/how we know the past; hunter-gatherers, nomadism, fire, tools. [High - core text]

NCERT Class 6 - 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'

Beginning of agriculture, domestication of plants/animals, Neolithic, Mehrgarh, pottery. [High - core text]

NCERT Class 6 - 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4 'In the Earliest Cities'

Harappan cities, town planning (Citadel/Lower Town), drains, crafts, metallurgy, Lothal trade. [High - core text]

NCERT Class 6 - 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.5, 7 & 8

Burials/megaliths & Vedas; Buddhism/Jainism & Ahimsa (Mahavira, Buddha); Ashoka & the Kalinga war. [High - core text]

SCERT Telangana Class 6-8 Social Studies (thematic units)

Early humans, production & crafts, religion & society, culture over time. [Medium - confirm exact lesson in your edition]

[!] Age-labels (Chalcolithic / Iron Age) & precise dates

Terminology and dating are treated more fully in Class 9 / higher texts and standard references. [Verify before use]

Honesty note for the reviewer: please check every [!]-flagged item against a Class 9/higher text before using it with students. Human verification of these references is expected and encouraged.